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STATE OF NEW HAMPSHIRE
DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES
DIVISION OF LONG TERM SUPPORTS AND SERVICES
BUREAU OF DEVELOPMENTAL SERVICES

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Date: January 1, 2026

To: Area Agencies, Provider Agencies, Service Coordination Agencies, BDS Staff, and NH Guardianship Agencies

From: Jessica Gorton, Bureau Chief
NH Bureau of Developmental Services (BDS)

Re: **2026 Standard of Need and Income Changes**

The Division of Economic Stability (DES), Bureau of Family Assistance (BFA) has announced there is a 2.8% increase for 2026 in Social Security Administration (SSA) benefits, Supplemental Security Income (SSI) benefits, and the Standard of Need (SON) for individuals receiving financial assistance under New Hampshire's Adult Assistance categories. SSA/SSI benefit levels will increase to **\$994** per month, formerly \$967.

The SON levels for individuals eligible for Medicaid under Aid to the Permanently and Totally Disabled (APTD), Old Age Assistance (OAA), and Aid to the Needy Blind (ANB) are as follows:

For an individual in independent living;

- **\$1,008 per month** formerly \$981

For an individual living in an He-M 1001 Certified Staffed Residence, He-M 521 Certified Family Setting, or He-M 525 Certified Family Setting with a residential service;

- **\$1,070 per month** formerly \$1,043

For an individual living in an He-M 1001 Certified Enhanced Family Care residence, or an He-M 525 Certified Enhanced Family Care residence.

- **\$1,188 per month** formerly \$1,161

BDS will apply the \$27/month increase to the Personal Needs Allowance (PNA). PNA for individuals receiving BDS Waiver Services will increase to \$222/month, formerly \$195 per month, for individuals residing in a staffed residence or enhance family care home. Individuals living independently or in their family's home will have a PNA equal to the Nursing Facility Cap.

Maximum residential fees, based on the individual's social security amount, will remain unchanged as listed below:

- **\$848** for He-M 1001 Certified Staffed Residences, He-M 521 Certified Family Setting; or He-M 525 Certified Family Setting with a residential service; and
- **\$966** for individuals in He-M 1001 Certified Enhanced Family Care Residences or He-M 525 Certified Enhanced Family Care residences.

The Nursing Facility (NF) Cap, used for Medicaid financial eligibility determinations has increased to **\$2,982** from \$2,901 per month; GROSS income must be equal to or less than **\$2,982/month**. Individuals with monthly income in excess of \$2,982 may be able to "Spend Down" to the Protected Income Limit (PIL) to gain Medicaid eligibility; the PIL for an individual remains the same at \$916 per month.

If you have questions, you may contact BDS@dhhs.nh.gov, the BDS main line at 603-271-5034, or your regional liaison.

BDS Regional Liaison contact list:

<https://www.dhhs.nh.gov/sites/g/files/ehbemt476/files/documents2/bdsregionalliaisonlist.pdf>